

BAL Ratings — When You Need One



Bushfire attack level assessments for Class 10a work.

A BAL assessment isn't needed on every job, but where it is, we can't complete the assessment without it. If you're unsure whether your lot is affected, ask us before you lodge — it takes a moment to check and saves a round trip.

WHAT WE NEED TO SEE

- ✓ The BAL assessment or certificate itself — not just the rating quoted in an email
- ✓ Prepared by a person accredited to determine it
- ✓ The lot address matching your application
- ✓ The BAL rating stated clearly
- ✓ The date of the assessment
- ✓ Where the rating is BAL-40 or BAL-FZ, construction details on the plans to match

COMMON REASONS WE COME BACK

- ✗ A rating mentioned in an email with no assessment attached
- ✗ An assessment for a neighbouring lot, or an earlier stage of the subdivision
- ✗ A high rating with no corresponding construction detail on the drawings
- ✗ An assessment that predates a change to the lot or the surrounding vegetation

WHAT THE RATINGS MEAN FOR YOUR JOB

- BAL-LOW — no specific bushfire construction requirements apply.
- BAL-12.5, BAL-19, BAL-29 — increasing levels of ember and radiant heat protection; construction requirements step up with each level.
- BAL-40 — significant radiant heat exposure with some direct flame contact; substantial construction requirements.
- BAL-FZ — flame zone, the highest level; the most onerous construction requirements apply.
- Where the rating is BAL-40 or BAL-FZ, the drawings need to show how the construction meets it.

Not sure whether your lot is bushfire prone? Check the lot against the DFES Bushfire Prone Areas map, or send us the address and we'll confirm before you lodge.

